

“I love the name of honour  
more than I fear death.”

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, JULIUS CAESAR, 1599

44 BCE

## ASSASSINATION OF JULIUS CAESAR

As Julius Caesar made his way to a meeting of the Roman Senate in the spring of 44 BCE, he was already dictator for life and many feared that he intended to make himself king. As Caesar took his seat, a group of senators led by Marcus Brutus and Cassius Longinus struck him down with daggers. The assassination sparked a new civil war.

▷ *Death of Caesar* by Vincenzo Camuccini



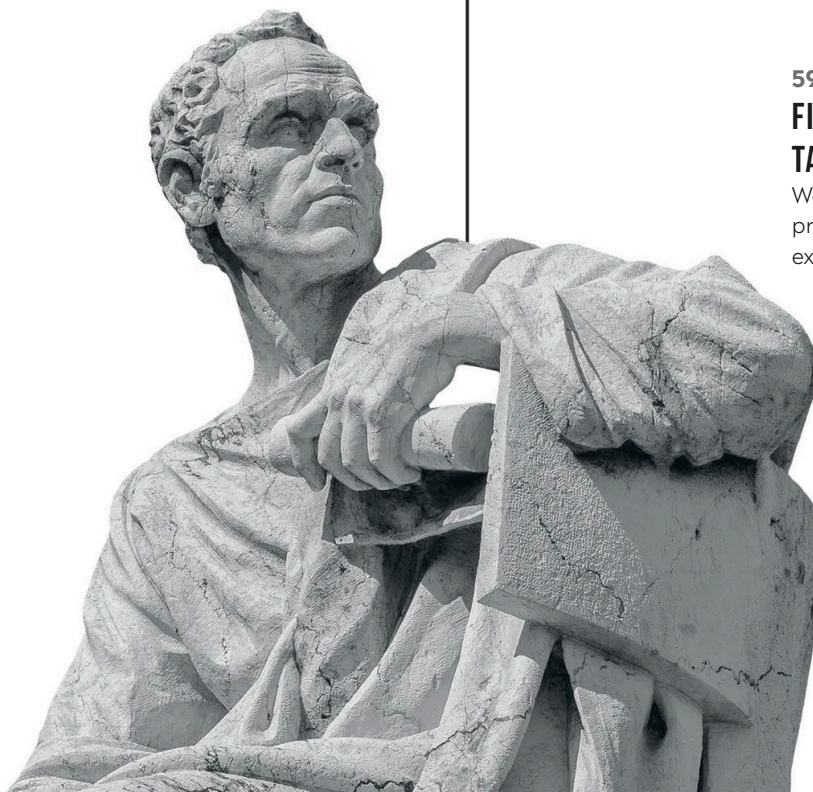
60 BCE

**60 BCE Establishment of Han protectorate** of the Western Regions extends Chinese control northwest into the Tarim Basin

**58 BCE Julius Caesar** begins the conquest of Gaul, subjugating it within eight years

**55 BCE Julius Caesar** invades Britain and returns the following year, but ultimately withdraws

**46 BCE Roman calendar is reformed**, having fallen 80 days out of alignment with the seasons



59 BCE

## FIRST TRIUMVIRATE TAKES POWER IN ROME

Weary at the political chaos of the preceding decades, Julius Caesar, ex-governor of Spain, joined with statesman Crassus and fellow general Pompey in a triumvirate to govern Rome, excluding the Senate from power. Crassus's death in battle against the Parthians in 53 BCE and increasing friction between Pompey and Caesar caused the triumvirate's collapse, culminating in Caesar marching an army into Italy in 49 BCE and the outbreak of civil war.

◁ **Lucius Licinius Crassus**, Roman senator